

Bethany Thomas

KYC & Compliance Specialist · Front-End Developer · Data Analyst

Liverpool, England | gekkzzz.co.uk | github.com/gekkzzz | [LinkedIn](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

FCA-regulated compliance and KYC specialist with 2+ years at Starling Bank, one of the UK's leading digital banks — processing high-volume personal and business onboarding, AML, sanctions screening, and financial crime detection. Pairs regulatory depth with hands-on full-stack development (React, TypeScript, Supabase) and data skills (Python, R) gained through live deployed projects and a DataCamp Associate Data Analyst Certification. Holds a 2:1 BSc Econ from Cardiff University. Seeking roles where compliance expertise, technical ability, and analytical rigour intersect.

CORE SKILLS

Compliance & Financial Crime: KYC, EDD, AML, FCA Guidelines, GDPR, Sanctions & PEP Screening, SIRA, CIFAS, Fraud Detection, UBO Identification, Adverse Media, Risk Frameworks, QA

Front-End Development: React, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, Vite, Responsive Design, Accessibility (A11y), Semantic HTML

Back-End & Data: Supabase, REST APIs, Python, R, Statistical Analysis, Data Wrangling — DataCamp Certified Associate Data Analyst

Tools: Git, GitHub, VS Code, Vercel, CI/CD pipelines, Adobe Creative Cloud, DaVinci Resolve

WORK EXPERIENCE

Starling Bank · **Onboarding Associate** · Aug 2023 – Present · Remote

- Processed KYC and Enhanced Due Diligence for thousands of personal and business clients, maintaining full compliance with FCA, AML, GDPR, Sanctions and PEP requirements across a sustained high-volume caseload — zero compliance failures recorded.
- Identified and escalated fraud and financial crime indicators via SIRA and CIFAS, directly reducing risk exposure for Starling's onboarding pipeline while sustaining rigorous QA standards.
- Produced complex corporate ownership analyses and written risk assessments on high-risk client profiles, enabling senior reviewers to reach faster, better-evidenced decisions.
- Worked cross-functionally with operations to map and fix workflow bottlenecks in the onboarding journey, reducing customer drop-off while maintaining strict regulatory compliance.
- Maintained GDPR-compliant data handling end-to-end across the client lifecycle, building information governance habits directly transferable to engineering and software environments.

McDonald's · **Crew Trainer** · Jan 2023 – Aug 2023 · Cardiff

- Trained and signed off new team members on operational procedures and service standards, improving onboarding speed and consistency in a high-throughput environment.
- Maintained HACCP food safety compliance and operated EPOS and digital ordering systems, consistently exceeding speed and accuracy targets.

PROJECTS

Solo Full-Stack · React, TypeScript, Supabase · **Handshake — Skill-Exchange Social Platform** ·

In Development

- Building a full-stack social platform enabling peer-to-peer skill exchange (e.g. piano lessons for plumbing tuition) — architected end-to-end from product concept through UI/UX, front-end build, and Supabase database design.
- Supabase back end handles authentication, user profiles and real-time data; React + TypeScript front end prioritises accessibility and responsive design.
- Sole owner of product, design, and engineering — demonstrating ability to take a concept from 0 to deployed product independently.

Solo · TypeScript, CSS3, Vite, Vercel · **Apple-Inspired Responsive Website** · Solo · TypeScript, CSS3, Vite, Vercel · 2025

- Built a fully responsive, high-performance site inspired by Apple's minimalist design language using TypeScript and Vite. Source: github.com/gekkzzz/example-website-one

- Achieved strong Core Web Vitals scores through optimised asset loading, semantic HTML and A11y best practices; deployed via Vercel CI/CD pipeline for zero-downtime automated releases.

Personal Portfolio Website · Solo · Live

- Live at gekkzzz.co.uk — personal portfolio showcasing projects, skills and work history.

Swansea University Hackathon · Team Project · [Welsh Senedd Political Matcher](#) · 2020–2022

- Built a civic tech web app under competition conditions that matched voters to their most aligned Welsh political party based on policy preferences — combining data handling, user input logic and front-end presentation for a real public brief.

EDUCATION

Cardiff University · [BSc Econ International Relations & Politics — 2:1](#) · Sep 2022 – Jul 2025 · Cardiff

- Relevant modules: quantitative research methods, statistical analysis, international law, political economy, global governance — applied using Python and R for data-driven policy analysis.
- Co-founded Stronger Together student service — Secretary & Treasurer; awarded Cardiff University Student Led Service of the Year.
- Elected Student Senator, Accessibility Officer (Cardiff Students Union), and Vice-President of Labour Students Society.

Coleg Sir Gar · [A Levels](#) · 2019 – 2022 · Llanelli

- Law — A (Student of the Year, Highest Grade in Cohort) · Sociology — A · Welsh Baccalaureate — A · Government & Politics — B
- Elected Wellbeing Officer across all Coleg Sir Gar campuses.

CERTIFICATIONS & AWARDS

- DataCamp Associate Data Analyst Certification — applied through Python/R data wrangling and statistical analysis in university coursework
- Cardiff University: Student Led Service of the Year — Stronger Together
- Cardiff University: Contribution to Student Voice Award
- Coleg Sir Gar: Student of the Year in Law — Highest Grade in Cohort